International Teacher Education

BlackDeath VS Covid lesson plan

Student name	Dylan Schlepers
Student number	*5882966*
NHL- e-mail address	Dylan.schlepers@student.nhlstenden.com
Specialisation	History
Classcode	ITSB23V1MPES1-A
Supervisor(s)	La, Brian
Examiner(s)	La, Brian
Assessment date	4/11/2026

By handing in this product, I declare that the product is my own work and that it is free of plagiarism.

Template ITESS Lesson Plan

Part 1: General information

Student-teacher Dylan Schlepers	**Mentor-teacher (if applicable)** Melanie	**Date** 02/11/26
School (+ curriculum) International School IB MYP – Individual and Societies/ History	**Class level (grade, age)** 7 Grade (12-year-old)	**No. Students** 20
Length of the lesson 50 minutes	**Topic/content** Black Death vs Covid-19	**Materials (books, etc.)** PowerPoint presentation Classroom screen/projector Student Handout: *"Crises Across Centuries"* (Worksheet + Exit Ticket)

Learning aims	**Prior knowledge, attitudes, skills, etc.[1]**	**How to check students' progress towards the learning aims in this lesson?**
- Knowledge: Students will understand how global networks enabled the spread of Yernisa pestis (black death) from China into Europe - Analysis: Students will evaluate how labor shortages caused by the black death broke the - feudal system and compare this economic reset to post COVID-19 remote work.	- Prior Knowledge: Personal experience living through COVID-19 lockdowns, basic understanding of maps, general cultural awareness of medieval knights/castles. - Attitudes: Curiosity about global events, open to historical inquiry. - Skills: Basic source interpretation, listening comprehension, ability to draw parallels between past and present.	- *Formative checking:* Monitoring student responses during the 20-minute individual/pair worksheet activity and providing direct feedback. - *Plenary checking:* Evaluating student reasoning during the 10-minute group discussion of Task 1 & Task 2. - *Summative exit assessment:* Collecting and reviewing the physical 5-minute Exit Ticket to verify mastery of the feudal labor shift and the core Statement of Inquiry.

- Inquiry(conceptual): **Scale-Shifting (Micro-Macro Analysis):** Train students to shift perspective fluidly between the *micro-scale* (an individual flea, a human coughing, a personal lockdown room) and the *macro-scale* (global trade routes like the Silk Road, continental demographic collapses, and centuries of economic restructuring). **Collective Learning & Network Connectivity:** Analyze how human connectivity acts as a multiplier. Just as the Pax Mongolica and Silk Road accelerated the spread of *Yersinia pestis* in 1347, modern global aviation networks accelerated		

COVID-19 in 2020. The didactic tool here is comparing **network density** across time periods. **Thresholds of Complexity / Systemic Shocks:** Treat both pandemics as "bottlenecks" or systemic shocks that forced human societies to reorganize their energy, labor, and economic structures (e.g., the collapse of European feudalism vs. the shift toward remote work and digital automation). -		

TIME
0:00 - 15:00 *(15 mins)* Phase 1: Interactive Presentation & Hook
15:00 - 35:00 *(20 mins)* Phase 2: Independent/Pair Worksheet Activity
35:00 - 45:00 *(10 mins)* Phase 3: Plenary Discussion & Synthesis
45:00 - 50:00 *(5 mins)* Phase 4: Exit Ticket & Wrap-Up

Part 2 : Lesson plan[3]

TIME	CONTENT (What are you teaching?)	ACTIVITIES (How are teacher & students working?)	MOTIVATION (Why this activity/approach? Source-backed)
0:00-15:00 (15 mins) Phase 1: Interactive Presentation & Hook	Global Networks, Systemic Shocks & Feudal Shifts Slides 1-11: Statement of Inquiry ("Does history repeat itself?"), Pax Mongolica, Silk Road, Siege of Caffa, feudalism breakdown, plague doctors, and human reactions.	**Teacher:** Delivers 11-slide presentation using narrative storytelling. Uses interactive questions (e.g., deconstructing the plague doctor suit). **Students:** Actively listen, answer prompt questions, and observe visual comparisons between 1347 and 2020.	Inquiry-Based Learning & Big History (OER Project, n.d.): A concise, high-impact presentation hooks students, establishes interdisciplinary context, and frames history across **global networks and scale-shifting (micro-to-macro analysis)** before launching into independent practice.
15:00-35:00 (20 mins)	Task 1 (Mapping Technological vs. Behavioral Change) and	**Teacher:** Distributes the handout, clarifies instructions, and circulates the room to scaffold learning and	Constructivism & Active Learning: Students construct their own understanding by

Phase 2: Independent/Pair Worksheet Activity	Task 2 (Analyzing Systemic Shocks and Human Continuity).	provide formative support. **Students:** Work individually or in pairs to complete the comparison table and write their reflection.	directly processing the presentation's concepts into a comparative framework, using **network connectivity and threshold thinking** to anchor historical facts to their lived experiences of COVID-19.
35:00-45:00 (10 mins) Phase 3: Plenary Discussion & Synthesis	Classroom Sharing & Debrief Synthesizing findings on global networks, labor shifts (feudalism vs. remote work), and human fear/isolation.	**Teacher:** Guides a classroom debrief, pulling answers from different student pairs and highlighting key themes on the board. **Students:** Share their worksheet answers, compare findings with peers, and refine their ideas.	Social Constructivism (Vygotsky): Peer discussion allows students to articulate their reasoning, hear alternative perspectives, and solidify abstract historical connections through dialogue, evaluating **constants vs. variables** across centuries.
45:00-50:00 (5 mins) Phase 4: Exit Ticket & Wrap-Up *(Phase 5: Medical Myths & Reactions)* *(Phase 6: Conclusion & Synthesis)*	Summative Inquiry Check Handout Exit Ticket: MCQ on feudal labor system changes and short reflection on whether history repeats itself. Slide 9: Miasma theory, herbal beaks, accidental protection vs. modern germ	**Teacher:** Instructs students to complete the Exit Ticket at the bottom of their handout and collects them. Prompts students on medical myths and concludes with the software metaphor. **Students:** Individually complete the two questions and hand them in as they leave. Analyze images and reflect on the main takeaway.	Assessment FOR Learning: Provides immediate, individual data on mastery of core learning aims. Interactive Source Analysis & Constructivism forces students to evaluate medieval reasoning without modern condescension, consolidating learning through a **Big History systemic framework** ("Software stays the same, environment changes").

	theory and masks. Slide 10 & 11: Synthesis of takeaways. The "Human Software vs. Environment" metaphor.		